I've Got To Break Free

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39609600.

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Character:
Swift Wind (She-Ra)

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I've Got To Break Free

by TheSofterGentlerMe

Summary

Swift Wind is just a horse sitting in the barn at Camp Horde for the Lord. However, he senses that it's time to make a change. It's time to break free.

Notes

Shall we?

Inspired by a headcanon comment on the original story in this series from Randox_Talore. Thank you for the great idea!

See the end of the work for more notes

Swift Wind sat in the barn. He shook his head, not sure what to do. It'd been so long since he'd seen Adora and he hardly ever got out of the stall now. Someone came around and fed the horses, walked them around the corral for exercise, but the kids never came around. Someone had come and taken out almost all the horses a week before and they'd never returned. It was heading on towards nightfall and a little breeze blew through the barn as Swift Wind looked at the gate across the front of his stall. Something in the breeze seemed to say it was time to go.

First, he nudged at the gate. Nothing. He wasn't surprised. It'd been a long time since he'd been able to move the stall gate that way. Then he leaned his head against the gate a little further down and pushed up against it. It rattled a little but the latch had been specifically built to avoid him pushing it up and over that way. He sat there and looked at the gate some more, waiting. The mind of a horse is a different place than the mind of a human but a human might say he was scheming and that wasn't far off.

Swift Wind got turned around in his stall and gave the gate a light kick. It rattled and spooked the other horses but held firm. He circled in his stall a few times, the memory of Adora in his head, and he stopped and kicked the stall gate again. Again, it rattled but held firm while the other horses started getting agitated. It was at that moment that Joshua, the camp director, came walking into the barn.

"Stupid horse," Joshua said as he stared at Swift Wind. "You're more trouble than you're worth and no one wants the rest of you nags for riding. Well, no more feed bill at least. I at least found someone that'll take you and at least you'll get rendered into something useful."

Swift Wind didn't really understand what was being said but he'd always disliked Joshua and the tone of his voice was all wrong. His ears pinned back as his tail quickly started swishing as Joshua spent a few minutes gathering up some paperwork from a board nailed between two posts that served as a desk for the barn before walking out. After a few minutes of more pacing, Swift Wind finally turned around and slammed his hind legs against the gate again. It was reinforced, it wasn't the first time he'd tried this, and normally would give up after a time or two of kicking. He didn't give up this time. He kept kicking, the iron shoes on his feet splintering the wood with every kick, and then he felt the gate move open. He turned around, not knowing he'd shattered the latch that held the gate shut. He was a horse, he didn't care, he just saw an open gate and went out.

The barn doors were shut but that wouldn't have been a problem for him, it never had been in the past and after reinforcing his stable no one had ever thought to do the same for the doors, but now he stopped as the remaining horses seemed to be staring at him. Swift Wind started towards the door and then stopped before turning around and carefully opening every stall gate. These were easy and soon he was surrounded by six other horses, milling around. They weren't top notch horses. They were gentle but old and most places wouldn't take a risk on them. The only reason Swift Wind was even still there was because it was obvious he was a nightmare of a horse to deal with. Which he shortly proved.

"What!? How!?" all the horses heard. They all turned to see Joshua standing at the now half open barn door, drawn back by reports of banging noises from the barn. "Get back in the stalls!"

Joshua grabbed a never used riding crop off the wall by the door and started towards the horses. Then he was suddenly moving for his life as Swift Wind ran straight at him, six other horses falling in right behind him. He barely managed to avoid getting trampled by Swift Wind, although one of the horses did body check him hard enough to bounce him off a stall gate, and he lay on the ground shaking his head to clear it as the sounds of thundering hoofs faded in the early evening air.

The following morning, Adora woke up to Catra furiously shaking her. She sat up in the small bed in the little trailer they lived in at Camp Bright Moon to see Catra wordlessly pointing out the window.

"Catra, what are you… *is that Swift Wind!?"*

The trailer sat in the backyard of the house the camp directors lived in and in that backyard stood Swift Wind, gently cropping the grass before looking up at Adora as she and Catra almost fell out of the door in their rush to get out as if to say, "Hey, haven't seen you in a bit. How've you been?"

The other six horses became something of an area legend. People spotted them roaming up and down the river corridor, flitting in and out of the cottonwood breaks along the river and just living the last years of their lives doing whatever they wanted as they avoided anyone who tried to catch them. As to Swift Wind, Joshua never did find out where he ended up and filed insurance papers on him, and all the other horses, claiming he'd drowned. In reality, he ended up in the Camp Bright Moon stables where he still had the habit of breaking out. However, he generally came back fairly quickly, often before people even noticed. After all, the

stable was nicer than his last one, he got way more apples for snacks, and Adora went by often to dote on him when she was around. What more could a horse want?

End Notes

As I mentioned in the opening notes, this came about because Randox_Talore made a comment that they headcanoned that Swift Wind made it across the river to Adora. I kind of alluded to that fact that Tara was going to get the horses but I never really specified that Swift Wind was going to be one of them so I figured, hey, that's a pretty cool idea and ran with it. Thank you for reading and thank you again, Randox_Talore.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!